
HS 631: Historical Theory and Methodology

Course Code	HS 631
Course Name	Historical Theory and Methodology
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Consent of the course instructor
Intended for	PG
Distribution	Elective for HSS
Approval	8th Senate (Oct 2015)

Course Contents

- **The Emergence of Modern Historiography** [2 Lectures]
 - The disenchantment with the Enlightenment
 - The rise of romanticism and idealism
 - Nationalism, positivism and the rise of the modern practice of history writing
- **Positivism, Idealist History and Other Early Approaches** [4 Lectures]
 - Georg Wilhelm Friedrich Hegel
 - * dialectics
 - * world spirit
 - * consciousness
 - * universal history
 - Leopold von Ranke
 - * objectivity
 - * the primacy of facts
 - Thomas Babington Macaulay
 - * progress and linear history
 - Thomas Carlyle
 - * the great man theory
 - R.G. Collingwood
 - * history as the study of the mind
 - * the autonomy of action
 - * reenactment
 - Arnold Toynbee
 - * challenge and response
 - * the creative minority
- **Marxist History** [10 Lectures]
 - Karl Marx
 - * production and class relations
 - * historical materialism
 - * commodity fetishism
 - * the theory of surplus value
 - * alienation
 - * reification
 - Frederic Engels
 - * evolutionary history
 - * the interface of anthropology and history
 - * dialectical materialism
 - Antonio Gramsci
 - * dominance and hegemony

- * culture
- * war of manoeuvre and war of position
- Foucault
- * anti-humanism
- * epistemological break
- * anti-historicism
- * overdetermination
- * ideological state apparatus
- British Marxist historiography
- * Maurice Dobb
- * Rodney Hilton
- * Edward P. Thompson
- * Christopher Hill
- * Eric J. Hobsbawm
- Literature and History
- * Christopher Caudwell
- * George Thomson
- * Georg Lukacs
- * Raymond Williams
- * Terry Eagleton
- Annales School [8 Lectures]
- Mark Bloch and Lucien Febvre
- * the departure from political history
- * economic structures and relationships iii) geography and history
- Fernand Braudel
- * time and structure
- * geography and longue durée processes
- * capitalism and civilization
- History of Mentalities
- * Georges Duby: the three orders
- * Jacques Le Goff: merchants, churches and their time and imagination
- * Emmanuel Le Roy Ladurie: rural life
- Quantitative history
- * Ernest Labrousse
- * Pierre Chaunu
- Cultural practices
- * Roger Chartier
- The Narrative
- Fredric Jameson
- * the political unconscious
- * narrative as a socially symbolic act
- Paul Ricoeur
- * time and narrative
- * mimesis
- Louis Mink
- * representation and narrative
- * narrative and cognition
- Hayden White
- * the critique of narrative history
- * emplotment

- * literary narrative and the historical narrative
- the Linguistic Turn [6 Lectures]
 - Jacques Derrida
 - * deconstruction
 - * difference
 - * arch-writing
 - Michael Foucault
 - * discourse analysis
 - * discursive formation
 - * archaeology and genealogy
 - Jean-François Lyotard
 - * the critique of the metanarrative
 - Stephen Greenblatt
 - * new historicism
- 7. Oral Tradition [3 Lectures]
 - Formulaic composition
 - * Milman Parry
 - * Albert Lord
 - Oral tradition as history
 - * Jan Vansina
 - * David Henige
 - Oral history
 - * Evidence and authenticity
 - * shared authority
- Analysis [5 Lectures]
 - Causality
 - * Mono-causal explanations
 - * Multi-causal explanations
 - * Internal and external causes
 - * Laws of causality
 - The nature of generalization
 - * Difference between generalization and universalization
 - * Generalization and the laws of historical causation
 - Argument-building
 - Facts and argument
 - Conjecture
 - Logic in argument-building
 - Rhetoric

References

(Selections from the following works)

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